

CS 170 Java Tools

This semester in CS 170 we'll be using the **DrJava** Integrated Development Environment. You're free to use other tools but this is what you'll use on your programming exams, so you'll need to be familiar with it. The version of DrJava we'll be using has been *customized* for CS 170 to include built-in style checking and providing feedback on your programming assignments. This short document will show you how to download and configure it on your own personal computer.

Step 1: Got Java?

Before you can run DrJava, you first need to have (*at least*) the **Java** runtime (JRE) on your computer. If you have a Mac (and you run Software Update regularly), Java should be installed and correctly configured. (On Mac Lion, you'll be asked if you want to install a Java Runtime the first time you start a Java application.) With Windows and Linux, just visit <http://java.com>



Click the link that says **Free Java Download** (1) and follow the instructions to install the program. If you want to see if you already have Java installed before you start, just click the hyperlink that says "Do I have Java installed" (2). *If you have 64-bit Windows 7, use IE-64-bit to install the JRE. You can have both the 64 and 32 bit versions, but you'll need the 64-bit version on Windows 7-64 to use DrJava.*

For most of the class, you can use **just** the JRE (Java Runtime Environment) because DrJava contains its own copy of the **Eclipse** compiler, already built-in. If you want to use the DrJava debugger or the Javadoc documentation tool, though, you'll need to install the **Java Development Kit** (or **JDK**) which doesn't take that long.

Step 1-Alternative: Install the JDK

The **Java Development Kit** (or **JDK**) is a free set of command-line tools available from Oracle. If you download and install the JDK, it will also install the JRE, so you don't have to do both. Note that the JDK is a larger download than the JRE, however.

Here's how to install the JDK:

- If you have a Mac (and you run Software Update regularly), the JDK should be installed and correctly configured.
- If you are using Ubuntu Linux you should be able to install and configure Java using the shell command **sudo apt-get install sun-java6-jdk**
- If you are using Windows or another version of Linux, download the JDK (not the JRE) for your particular platform at: <http://java.sun.com/javase/downloads/index.jsp>



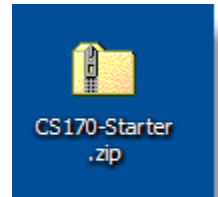
- Then, follow the installation instructions at:
<http://java.sun.com/javase/6/webnotes/install/index.html>

Note: you'll find the Java 6 version of the JDK at the bottom of the page shown here. The current version is JDK 7. The IDE we used in last Fall did not work with JDK 7, but the current version seems to work fine. We are still using JDK 6 in the labs, though, so you might have an easier time if you stick with Java 6. You can also install both the Java 6 and the Java 7 JDKs if you like.

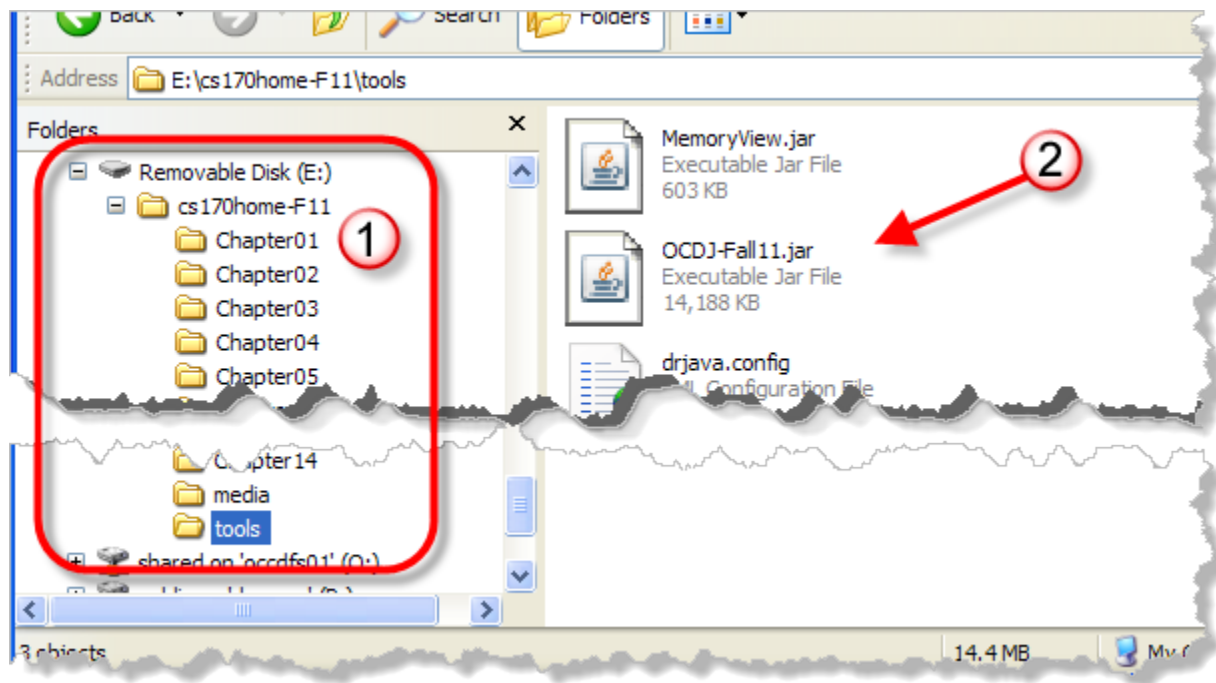
Note: if you are using Linux, you *can't* use the GNU version of Java, **gcj**. One way to check is to type **java -version** in a shell window. Even though **gcj** doesn't work, if you have **OpenJDK** already installed, it may work fine. If you are using Windows-7-64-bit, then download the 64-bit version of the JDK. That's what we have in the labs.

Step 2: Call the Doctor

Start by downloading the Zip file **cs170home-SU12.zip** from Blackboard. You can put it on your desktop or in your documents folder. Once you've downloaded it, unzip it on your local machine. (Make sure that you actually *unzip* the file. Don't use the Windows feature that lets you treat the file as a compressed folder. If the zipped file looks like the picture here—with a zipper up the middle—then right-click it and choose **Extract All** from the context menu.)



Once you've unzipped **cs170home-SU12.zip** you'll find a **folder** named **cs170home-SU12**. This is the folder that contains **DrJava** and all of the starter files and test code that accompanies the online textbook we'll be using this semester. Go ahead and drag it wherever you want to keep it. In the picture shown below, you can see that I've dragged the folder [the Fall 2011 version in the picture] to a USB drive:



As you can see, the **cs170home-SU12** folder has a subfolder named **tools**, as well as folders for each chapter in the textbook. Open the **tools** folder and **double-click** our customized version of DrJava, **OCDJ-Summer12.jar**. If all is well, you'll see the DrJava "splash screen" appear as DrJava loads for the first time.



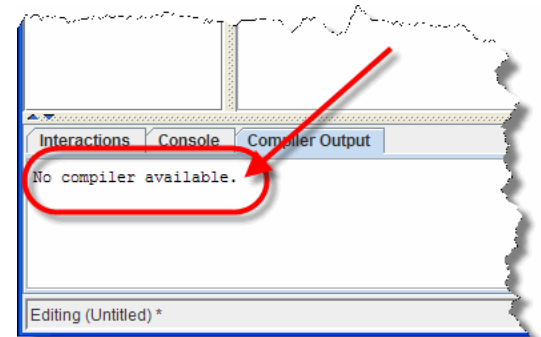
Of course the picture shown here shows the Fall-11 version instead of Summer 2012. I didn't want to re-shoot.

Troubleshooting Your Installation

DrJava doesn't start. If you have an "unarchiver" program like WinZip installed, it's possible for that program to "grab" the JAR (Java Archive) file extension, so that when you double-click the file it gets unzipped instead. (This may happen in different version of Linux as well.) If that occurs, open a command shell window, switch to the folder containing the Jar file, and type the command:
java -jar OCDJ-Summer12.jar.

Moving the JAR: You *can* move the **OCDJ-Summer12.jar** file, but it **must** be started from a folder that also contains the **drjava.config** file from the original download. I have had some problems with Windows 7 *erasing* the drjava.config file when it can't save correctly, so you may want to keep another copy of that file available.

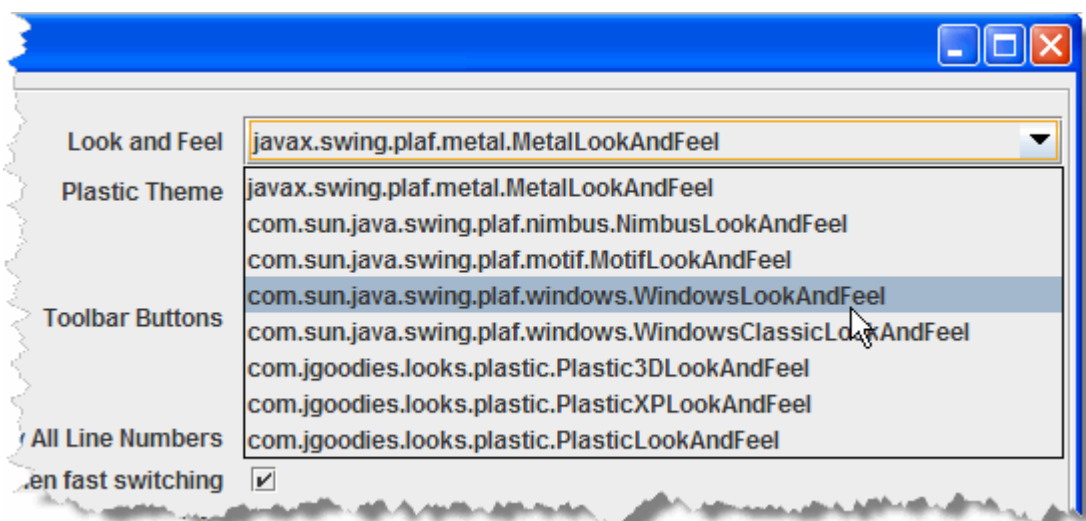
No compiler available. If you've tried the JRE only installation, when you start up DrJava on a machine without a JDK, you may see the message shown here when your program starts up. This should only occur on a machine that has an older version of Java installed.



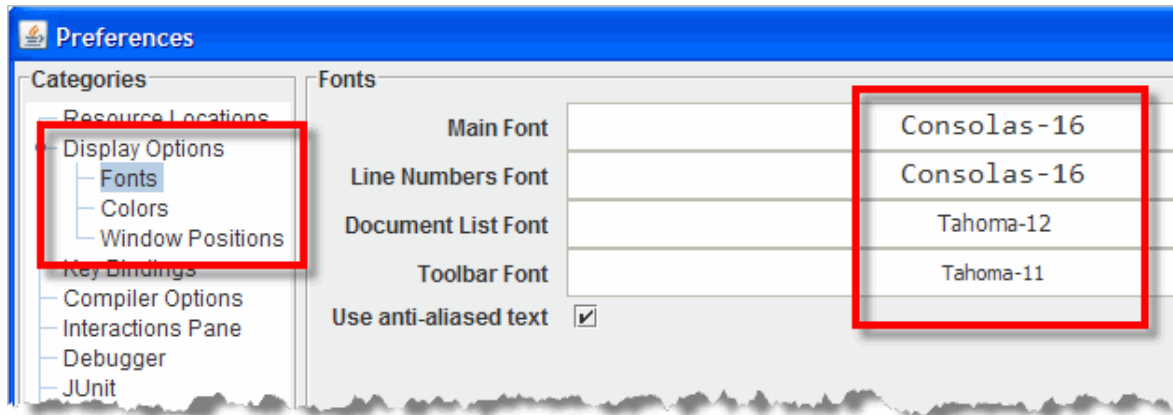
The easiest fix is to make sure that you have a current version of Java installed by following the instructions in **Step 1: Got Java?**

Step 3: Have It Your Way

I'll leave it to you to explore and to customize DrJava to your taste. Use the **Edit->Preferences** menu (on the Mac, you'll find it at **OCDrJava->Preferences** from the Mac menu at the top of the screen), make your changes. I've modified the CS 170 custom version of DrJava so that it uses the native look-and-feel of the Window system. You can switch to a different look and feel if you like:



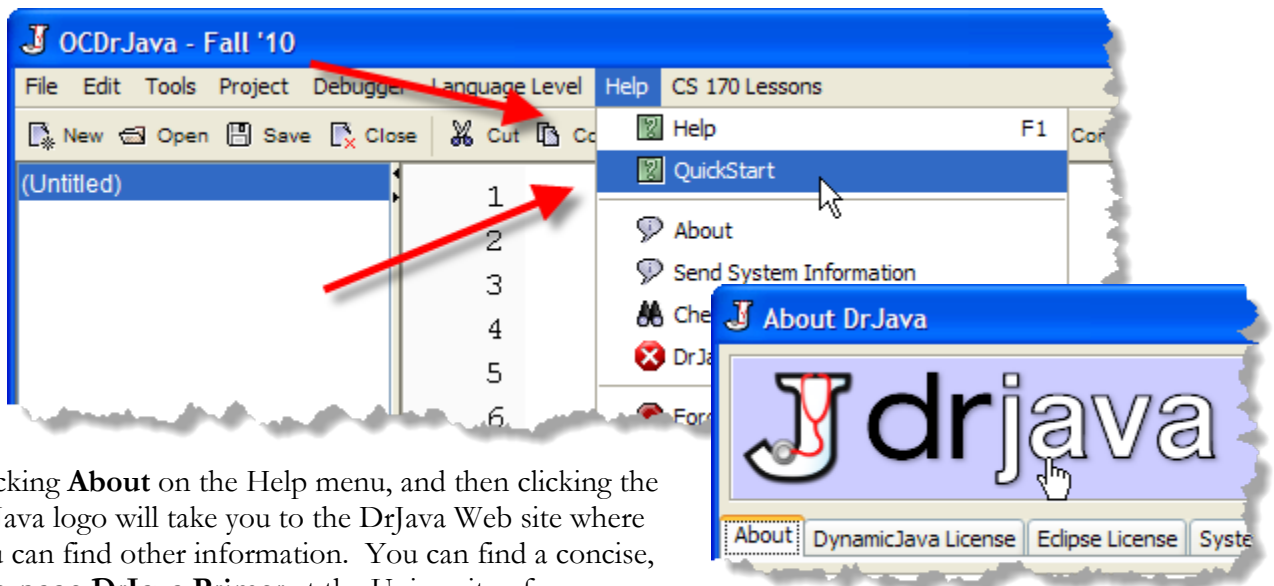
I also find that the default fonts are really too small for me to see. These are the settings I use on Windows. Unfortunately, when I take my USB drive over to my Mac, I then have to change the fonts to something else, like Monaco. If you leave the fonts at **Monospace**, then they'll work correctly, if unattractively, on either system:



Feel free to explore and change the other options like Colors, Window Positions and Key Bindings (hot-keys), to make DrJava work the way that you want it to work. You can't really hurt the program. If something goes horribly wrong, just replace the **.config** file with the original.

Step 4: Where to Go Now?

Browse the **DrJava Quick Start** from the **Help** menu to get a quick overview of using DrJava. Use **F1** or **Help->Help** to read the DrJava reference manual.



Clicking **About** on the Help menu, and then clicking the DrJava logo will take you to the DrJava Web site where you can find other information. You can find a concise, **one-page DrJava Primer** at the University of Pennsylvania:

<http://www.seas.upenn.edu/~cis1xx/resources/drjava/primer/>